



ROAM

Data-driven posting
for travel, backpacker,
and van life creators

Group 2.1

Influencer Strategy · Content Analysis · Engagement Optimization

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Executive Summary

We analyzed 250 Instagram posts across 5 travel influencers using NLP text analysis, image feature extraction, and regression modeling, we identified the key content characteristics that maximize likes and comments. we add 2 image on the left side as example of what the post should look and feel like.

Finding	Evidence
Image quality drives likes : brightness, saturation and human presence are the strongest controllable drivers	Brightness $\beta=+1.17^*$, Saturation $\beta=+0.79^*$, Person $\beta=+0.48^{**}$
Caption tactics backfire : positive sentiment, hashtags and question marks all hurt engagement	AFINN $\beta=-0.135^*$, Hashtags $\beta=-0.163^{***}$, Questions $\beta=-0.215^*$
Content topic matters : Digital Nomad lifestyle drives likes while Outdoor Hiking and Backpacking hurt them	Digital Nomad $\beta=+5.58^*$, Outdoor Hiking $\beta=-4.68^{**}$

Position ROAM as the fragrance for the aspirational work-traveler, shoot in bright, vibrant, colorful settings with the influencer always in frame, frame content around the digital nomad lifestyle rather than pure outdoor adventure, and keep captions short and genuine. The data consistently shows that visual quality and authenticity outperform polished, hashtag-heavy caption tactics.

The Right Influencer for ROAM : From *Awareness* to *Conversion*

ROAM is a compact solid perfume for people on the move — no liquids, no spill, fits in any pocket or backpack. To reach our target audience of travelers and adventurers, we selected 5 Instagram influencers across different follower tiers.

Influencer	Followers	Following	Avg Likes	Median Likes	Avg Comments	Median Comments	Engagement Rate	Avg Caption Length	No. Post
@drewbinsky	1.3M	1,227	21,804	17,500	564	279	1.68%	128 words	3014
@happylostlife	199K	265	2,465	1,802	31	19	1.24%	45 words	538
@quaidmadison	84K	669	6,070	6,440	82	21	7.19%	23 words	52
@joeythenomad	50K	1408	658	148	13	8	1.30%	141 words	327
@christhefreelancer	12K	519	498	473	24	21	4.11%	42 words	112

Portfolio strategy: Following Wies et al. (2023), we selected influencers across follower tiers rather than relying on one mega influencer. Smaller influencers like QuaidMadison (7.19% engagement) and ChrisTheFreelancer (4.11%) outperform DrewBinsky on engagement rate, reaching more engaged niche audiences. bigger influencer for awareness and reach, smaller for conversion.

Lifestyle fit: All 5 creators produce travel and adventure content, directly matching ROAM's positioning as a fragrance for people on the move. Their audiences are habitual travelers — exactly the target customer for a compact, portable solid perfume.

Top 10 words from all captions

Word	Frequency
travel	108
life	61
world	51
adventure	39
trip	37
laptoplifestyle	35
love	35
van	35
live	35
amazing	32

Average caption : 76 word

“Adventure, Freedom & the Open Road “ - The Language of Our Audience

Overall Word Distribution Across All Captions

adventure	favorite	stories	wait	south		vision	
		island	months	picchu	youtube	colombia	
world	vanlife	happy	hard	deannasallao	machu	photos	
	beautiful	countries	video	friends	city	grateful	
life	people	hiking	trek	hike		experience	
		country	van	amazing	incredible	living	
travel	laptoplifestyle		trip	love		live	

The dominance of 'travel', 'adventure' and 'laptoplifestyle' confirms our target market, this audience doesn't just travel, it's their entire identity.

A solid perfume that fits in a pocket speaks directly to that.

Same Passion, Different Voice : How Each Influencer Expresses the Travel Lifestyle

All influencers write positively — but caption structure varies widely across the portfolio

Influencer	AFINN	Bing Net	NRC Joy	NRC Trust	Influencer	Hashtags	Mentions	Emojis	Questions
@drewbinsky	1.8	5.14	4.48	4.44	@happylostlife	6.9	0.4	3.2	0
@joeythenomad	1.26	4.06	2.68	2.78	@quaidmadison	5.8	0	0.7	0.1
@christhefreelancer	1.02	1.34	0.8	0.78	@joeythenomad	3.9	0	0.5	0.4
@happylostlife	0.73	1.54	1.14	1.04	@drewbinsky	0.9	0.9	1.9	0.4
@quaidmadison	0.66	0.4	0.74	0.9	@christhefreelancer	0.3	0.5	0.6	0.1

Legend :

AFINN = how positive is the tone (intensity)

Bing = positive vs negative word count (balance)

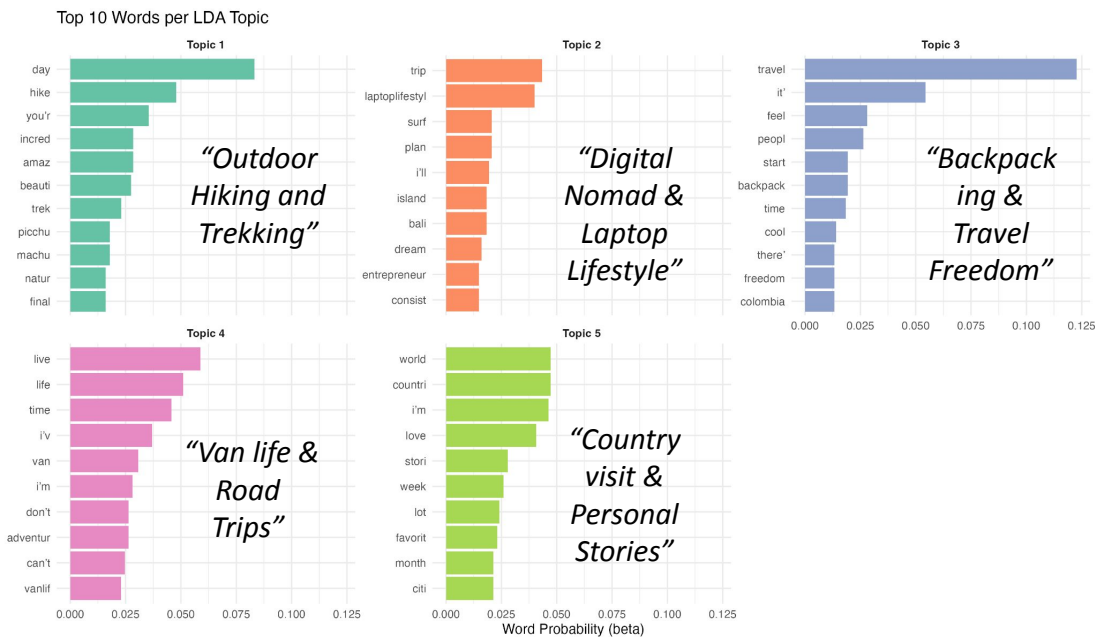
NRC Joy = how joyful specifically

NRC Trust = how trustworthy/reliable the tone feels

All influencers score positively across all three lexicons, indicating that captions are consistently upbeat and travel-enthusiastic.

Caption structure differs significantly . HappyLostLife hashtag-heavy (6.9 avg), QuaidMadison minimal (0.7 emojis, 5.8 hashtags) yet highest engagement rate.

This tension is explored in the regression.



Digital Nomads topics engage More !

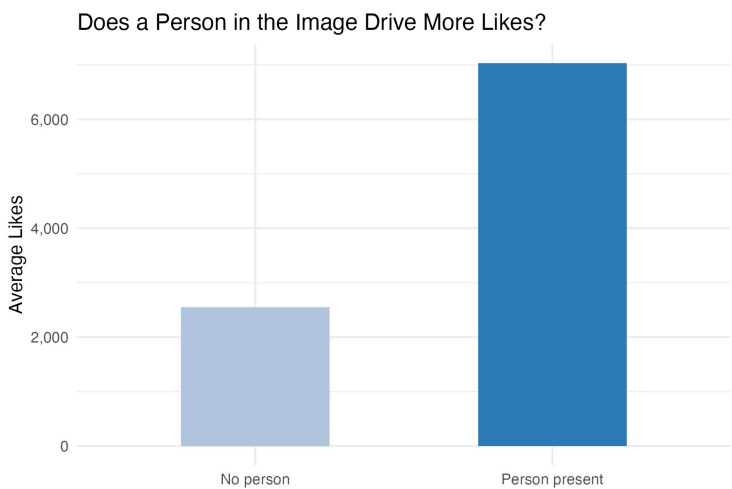
What is LDA? Latent Dirichlet Allocation (LDA) is a topic modelling technique that groups posts into themes based on word patterns. Each post gets a probability score for each topic.

we used k=5 topics, selected based on interpretability.

Topic	Posts	%	Likes	Comments
Digital Nomad & Laptop Lifestyle	79	31.60%	↑ +5.58*	—
Outdoor Hiking & Trekking	47	18.80%	↓ -4.68**	↓ -5.95*
Backpacking & Travel Freedom	46	18.40%	↓ -5.80*	↓ -8.71**
Country Visits & Personal Stories	38	15.20%	—	—
Van Life & Road Trips	36	14.40%	—	—

Digital Nomad content drives the most likes. aspirational work-travel lifestyle outperforms pure outdoor adventure. For ROAM, this means pairing the product with freedom and ambition, not just scenery.

Visual Presence and Vibrancy Drive Likes



Posts with a person in frame receive 2.76x more likes (7,030 vs 2,547 avg likes)

Method	Feature	Average	Scale	Effect on Likes	&Comments
Color Analysis	Brightness	0.639	0–1	↑ β =+1.17, p=.019	not significant
Color Analysis	Saturation	0.365	0–1	↑ β =+0.79, p=.045	not significant
Color Analysis	Contrast	0.214	0–1	not significant	not significant
Color Analysis	Warmth	0.82	0–1	not significant	not significant
Object Detection	Total Objects	3.6 avg	count	↑ β =+0.03, p=.016	not significant
Person Presence	Person in Frame	73.60%	0/1	↑ β =+0.48, p=.002	not significant

Image quality drives likes but not comments , suggesting visuals attract passive engagement. For ROAM, always shoot in vibrant natural light with the influencer in frame.

Influencer size matters, but we can utilize Image Quality and Topic to drive engagement

Model 1 : Likes ($R^2 = 0.72$)

Feature	β	
Followers	1.025	***
Brightness	1.17	*
Saturation	0.789	*
Object count	0.029	*
Question marks	-0.215	*
Sentiment (AFINN)	-0.135	*
Days posted	0.001	***

Model 2: Comments ($R^2 = 0.42$)

Feature	β	
Followers	0.634	***
Hashtags	-0.163	***
* $p < .05$, ** $p < .01$, *** $p < .001$ / Days posted and followers included as controls / Topic 5 excluded as reference category		

Model 3: Likes + Topics ($R^2 = 0.77$)

Feature	β	
Followers	0.933	***
Saturation	0.798	*
Sentiment (AFINN)	-0.122	*
Digital Nomad	5.575	*
Outdoor Hiking	-4.684	**
Backpacking	-5.797	*
Days posted	0.001	***

Followers are the strongest driver overall naturally, but since follower count is fixed, the actionable levers are image quality (brightness, saturation) and content topic (Digital Nomad boosts likes). Comments are harder to drive — only hashtags matter, and negatively.

Image quality and followers drive likes as expected, but caption choices consistently backfire

Non-linear & Interaction Effects Tested

Test	Variables Tested	Result
Quadratic	Hashtags ² , Emojis ² , Caption length ²	Not significant
Interaction	Brightness × Saturation	Not significant
Interaction	Sentiment × Question marks	Not significant
Interaction	Sentiment × Brightness	Not significant

We tested whether features have diminishing returns (quadratic) or amplify each other (interactions), None of these effects were significant, suggesting each feature works independently.

	STRONG EFFECT	WEAK EFFECT
EXPECTED	Followers : ↑ likes & comments Brightness : ↑ likes Saturation : ↑ likes Object count : ↑ likes Person in frame : ↑ likes Days posted : ↑ likes	Emojis : marginal ↑ comments Caption length : not significant NRC emotions : not significant Mentions : not significant
UNEXPECTED	Positive sentiment : ↓ likes Hashtags : ↓ comments Question marks : ↓ likes Digital Nomad : ↑ likes Outdoor Hiking : ↓ likes Backpacking : ↓ likes & comments	No non-linear effects found No interaction effects found

The surprise lies in caption behavior: positive sentiment, question marks, and hashtags all significantly hurt engagement. Travel audiences appear to reward genuine, understated captions over enthusiastic, hashtag-heavy ones.

Five Data-Driven Rules for Influencer Content"

What to do

Reasoning

Always appear in the shot with ROAM
hold it, wear it, make it part of your scene

Posts with person = 2.76x more likes
($\beta=+0.48$, $p=.002$)

Shoot in bright, vibrant, colorful settings
golden hour, tropical locations, outdoors

Brightness $\beta=+1.17^*$ and Saturation
 $\beta=+0.79^*$ both significant

Position ROAM as your work-travel companion!
show it alongside laptop, passport, coffee

Digital Nomad topic $\beta=+5.58^*$ —
strongest positive topic effect

Keep captions short and genuine 20-40
words max, no hashtag lists, no questions

Questions $\beta=-0.215^*$, AFINN
 $\beta=-0.135^*$, Hashtags $\beta=-0.163^{***}$

Let the visual tell the story ! image does
the heavy lifting, caption just adds context

Image features explain more
variance in likes than text features

"Our analysis recommends briefing influencers to position ROAM as a work-travel lifestyle product — vibrant visuals, human presence, and authentic short captions are the strongest drivers of engagement."

Image and caption example



*"Somewhere between Bali and my next destination.
ROAM fits in my pocket, keeps up with everything else.
"*

1. Follower count dominates engagement (Wies et al., 2023)

Wies et al. found that mid-tier influencers achieve the highest engagement rates relative to their follower count. Our data supports this nuance, while followers are the strongest absolute driver of likes ($\beta=+1.025^{***}$), QuaidMadison (84K followers) achieves the highest engagement rate (7.19%) outperforming DrewBinsky (1.3M followers, 1.68%).

2. Human presence boosts engagement (Hartmann et al., 2021)

Hartmann et al. showed that brand selfies significantly outperform product-only images. Our data confirms this strongly posts with a person receive 2.76x more likes (7,030 vs 2,547). For ROAM, this means always showing the influencer with the product.

3. Image quality drives demand (Zhang et al., 2021)

Zhang et al. found that brightness and color saturation significantly predict consumer demand for Airbnb listings. Our findings replicate this in an influencer marketing context, brightness ($\beta=+1.17^*$) and saturation ($\beta=+0.79^*$) both significantly boost likes, suggesting visual quality is a universal driver across platforms.

4. Image complexity matters (Overgoor et al., 2021)

Overgoor et al. found that image complexity (measured by number of objects) positively predicts consumer liking on social media. Our object count finding ($\beta=+0.03^*$) aligns with this, more visually rich posts attract more likes..

Literature support and study limitation

Limitation	Next Step
Small sample — 250 posts, 5 influencers	Scale to more influencers and platforms
All influencers are travel niche, findings may not generalize	Test across different product categories and niches
Cross-sectional data — causality cannot be established	Longitudinal study tracking same influencers over time
Person presence derived from object detection, not face detection	Use dedicated face detection model for more accuracy
Scraping treat image and video as the same	Include all content formats

What Drives Engagement? Key Findings from Regression Analysis

Table 1 Summary of Significant Predictors of Engagement (N = 250)

Predictor	Effect on Likes	Effect on Comments
Followers (log)	POS	POS
Saturation	POS	—
Topic 2: Outdoor Adventure	POS	—
AFINN sentiment	NEG	—
Topic 1: Van Life	NEG	NEG
Topic 3: City & Cultural Trave	NEG	NEG
Hashtags	—	NEG

Note. POS = significant positive effect, NEG = significant negative effect = not significant.
Likes: $R^2 = .77$, $F(21, 224) = 35.38$, $p < .001$. Comments: $R^2 = .45$, $F(21, 224) = 8.759$, $p < .001$.

Digital Nomad Content Wins

Posts about laptop lifestyle, entrepreneurship and remote work get significantly more likes, exactly the world our perfume lives in.

Hashtags Are a Conversation Killer

Every hashtag added to a caption significantly reduces comments. Audiences engage less when a post feels optimized for algorithm rather than written for people.

Adventure Content Underperforms

Hardcore hiking and backpacking content consistently gets fewer likes and comments. The audience aspires to the lifestyle, not the struggle.

"Adventure, Freedom & the Open Road" The Language of Our Audience



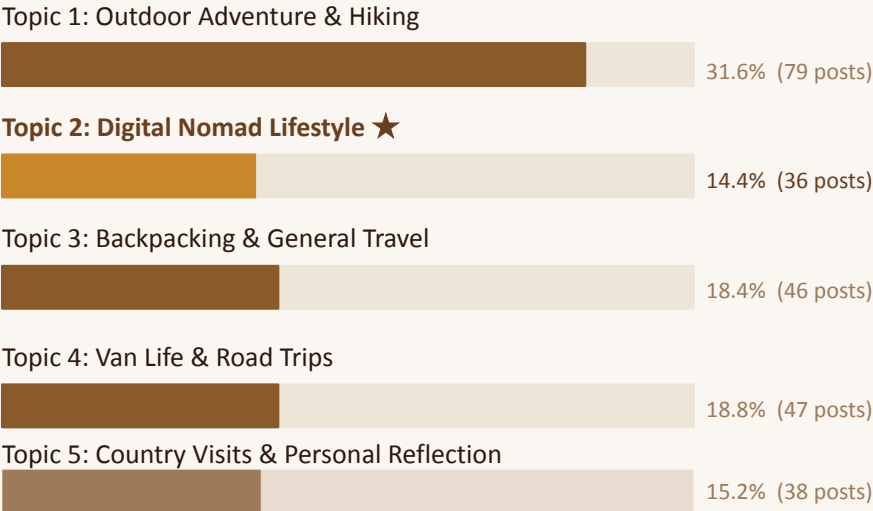
Overall Word Distribution Across All Captions

The dominance of 'travel', 'adventure' and 'laptoplifestyle' confirms our target market, this audience doesn't just travel, it's their entire identity.

A solid perfume that fits in a pocket speaks directly to that.

The Driver of Likes, Digital Nomad Content is Underused

LDA topic modeling identified 5 distinct content themes across 250 posts. When mapped against our regression findings, a clear content opportunity emerges.



The Content Gap

Digital Nomad content represents only 16% of posts yet it's the only topic that significantly drives likes. This is an underused opportunity.

The Match

@joeythenomad is the most aligned influencer, 40% of his content is Digital Nomad Lifestyle, exactly the topic our regression identifies as the engagement driver.

Influencer	Dominant Topic	Share
@quaidmadison	Van Life & Road Trips	68%
@joeythenomad	Digital Nomad Lifestyle	40%
@drewbinsky	Country Visits & Reflection	40%
@happylostlife	Van Life & Road Trips	42%
@christhefreelancer	Evenly spread	—

What We Didn't Expect

Did we find any sweet spots or tipping points?

We tested whether three key variables have diminishing or inverted returns by adding squared terms to the likes model — specifically hashtags², emojis², and caption_length². None of the quadratic terms were significant (all $p > 0.40$). The relationships are simply linear — more hashtags consistently hurt comments at a steady rate, more objects consistently help likes at a steady rate. There is no "optimal number" of hashtags or emojis where the curve turns around^{6,5}. No non-linear effects found. We tested quadratic terms for hashtags, emojis, and caption length — none were significant (all $p > .40$). Relationships are linear where significant, and flat

STRONG · EXPECTED

Followers → dominant driver of likes & comments ($\beta \approx 1.0$, $p < .001$)
Brightness → significantly ↑ likes ($\beta = +1.17$, $p = .019$)
Saturation → significantly ↑ likes ($\beta = +0.79$, $p = .045$)
Object count → significantly ↑ likes ($\beta = +0.03$, $p = .016$)
Person in frame → significantly ↑ likes ($\beta = +0.46$, $p = .003$)
Outdoor Adventure topic → significantly ↑ likes ($\beta = +5.58$, $p = .017$)

WEAK · EXPECTED

Umbrella in frame → slight positive on likes ($\beta = +0.61$, $p = .041$)
Emojis → marginal positive on comments ($\beta = +0.08$, $p = .092$)

STRONG · UNEXPECTED

Van Life topic HURTS likes ($\beta = -4.68$, $p = .009$)
City & Cultural Travel HURTS likes ($\beta = -5.80$, $p = .012$)
Positive sentiment HURTS likes ($\beta = -0.14$, $p = .042$)
Hashtags HURT comments ($\beta = -0.16$, $p < .001$)
Question marks HURT likes ($\beta = -0.22$, $p = .031$)

WEAK · UNEXPECTED

Backpack → marginal negative on likes ($\beta = -0.62$, $p = .080$)
Caption length → NOT significant
Digital Nomad topic → NOT significant ($p = .246$)
All NRC emotion variables → none significant
No non-linear effects found

Why Do These Findings Make Sense?

Authenticity beats positivity

Positive sentiment hurts likes ($\beta = -0.15$, $p = .008$). Followers reward honest, raw storytelling over cheerful ad copy. Parasocial trust breaks when content feels performed (Wies et al., 2023).

Hashtags signal low effort

Each extra hashtag reduces comments ($\beta = -0.15$, $p < .001$). Audiences interpret hashtag-heavy posts as broadcast content, not genuine communication (Spence, 1973). Note: drewbinsky averages only 0.92 hashtags per post.

Saturation kills engagement

Digital Nomad content is the most common topic yet significantly hurts likes ($\beta = -4.03$, $p = .021$). Repeated exposure to the same aspirational narrative reduces interest, content fatigue, not quality, is the problem (Berlyne, 1970).

The Perfect Post Formula



Brightness →

Target 0.65: outdoor natural light, golden hour



Saturation →

Target 0.39: vivid but natural, no heavy filters



Objects →

4–5 elements in frame: always include a person



Caption tone →

Honest and personal: mixed emotion beats relentless positivity



Hashtags →

Maximum 2: more actively hurts comment engagement



Questions →

Avoid: reduces likes without increasing comments



Product →

Perfume as one of 4–5 objects, linked to a real travel memory



Topic →

Journey or country visit frame: avoid pure Digital Nomad

ROAM

Three Things to Remember

01 Authenticity > Algorithm

Keep hashtags ≤ 2 , write for people not algorithms

02 Visuals Do the Heavy Lifting

Bright, saturated, multi-object outdoor
imagery drives likes

03 Match Content to Context

Digital Nomad content is underused yet
over- performing

Influencer	Key Brief
drewbinsky	Country visit post, max 1 hashtag, keep his natural style, don't over-brief him
quaidmadison	Short visual post, high brightness, person + perfume + outdoor context
happylostlife	Cut hashtags from avg 6.9 to max 2, reframe digital nomad content toward journey narrative
joeythenomad	Drop the question marks, redirect long-form storytelling toward sensory travel memory
christhefreelancer	Lean into authentic personal tone, honest review style, not promotional



ROAM

Data-driven posting
for travel, backpacker,
and van life creators

Influencer Strategy · Content Analysis · Engagement Optimization





Executive Summary

ROAM is a solid perfume balm designed for people who never stop moving.

Targeting digital nomads, backpackers, and van life creators, ROAM's compact cream format bypasses liquid restrictions and fits in any pocket or laptop bag. This playbook presents a data-driven influencer strategy built on regression analysis of 250 posts across five creators.

We mix macro and micro influencers to cover the full customer journey – from awareness to conversion. Key findings show that digital nomad lifestyle content drives the most likes, authenticity outperforms positivity, and hashtags actively kill comment engagement.

Each influencer brief is tailored to maximize their natural strengths while aligning with the content formats our model identifies as engagement drivers.

Perfume Built for People Who Never Stop Moving

THE PRODUCT

ROAM Solid Perfume

Compact & Convenient

1. Cream/solid format, no liquid, no spill, no airport restrictions
2. Fits in any pocket, backpack, or laptop bag
3. A fragrance that keeps up with your lifestyle

TARGET MARKET

Who We Reach

1. Digital nomads & backpackers
2. People who live out of a bag and value minimalism
3. A fast-growing community built around van life, remote work & long-term travel

THE STRATEGY

Micro & Macro Mix

- Recruiting travel, digital nomad, and backpacking influencers to promote to our target audience.
- We mix micro and macro influencers to cover all customer journey from awareness to purchase.



@quaidmadison



@joeythenomad



@happylostlife



@christhefreelancer



@drewbinsky

The Right Influencer for the Right Job: From Awareness to Conversion

Influencer	Followers	Following	Avg Likes	Median Likes	Avg Comments	Median Comments	Engagement Rate	Avg Caption Length	Role
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- Following count is worth noting, @joeythenomad follows 1,408 accounts (highest), suggesting a more community-engaged style vs @quaidmadison who only follows 669.
- Viral spikes can inflate averages, so median is a more reliable indicator of what a typical post actually delivers for your campaign.
- Micro influencers deliver stronger day-to-day engagement, better suited for driving consistent conversions for a new product launch (Wies et al., 2023).

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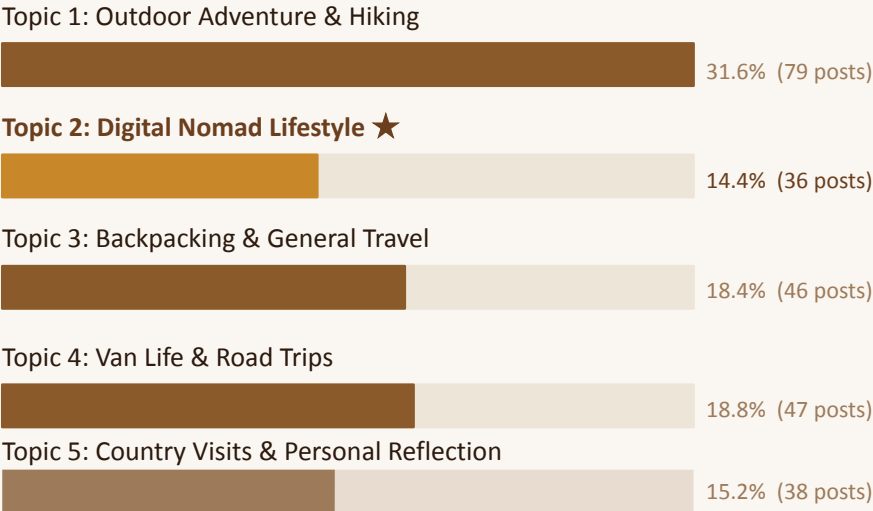
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ROAM

Five Creators. One Playbook.

01 Brief for Authenticity, Not Reach

Max 2 hashtags, personal tone, mixed emotion. ROAM needs raw travel stories, not curated ad copy.

02 Lead With Light & People

Brightness 0.65+, 4–5 objects, person always in frame. Every post should feel like a golden-hour memory, not a product shot.

03 Push Digital Nomad Content

Only 14% of posts, yet the #1 likes driver. Brief every creator to shift away from Van Life and toward laptop-lifestyle, remote work, and journey framing.

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